Without needing to fully understand the CoffeeScript shown here, you see that it can be converted to JavaScript on the fly as you enter it into the REPL. Whether entered into the REPL or written to a file to be compiled later, all of your CoffeeScript is converted to JavaScript before it runs. The CoffeeScript compiler gives you the CoffeeScript syntax that makes it easy for you to express your program the way you want.

1.6. Summary

CoffeeScript is the JavaScript you're already using—just with a new syntax. Remember those Vikings? They changed English forever because they didn't know or care how to handle the nuances of the language. The same goes for JavaScript, the most widely used programming language in the world. It won't remain unchanged in the face of all the different people who are starting to use it, and recent revisions to the language specification that take inspiration from the community (and CoffeeScript in at least one case) are clear evidence of that. Whether you plan to stick with JavaScript syntax at all costs or you're looking to move away from it, you'll be better off for your new understanding of CoffeeScript. Read on in the next chapter when you're ready to take a deeper look at the syntax.